



Presented by The High End



CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

Life-Size Blueprint — 3 Masts, 5 Sails, Flag, Ship's Wheel & Stern Castle

Build the three-masted pirate ship from the photo: your kid stands inside and steers from the ship's wheel.

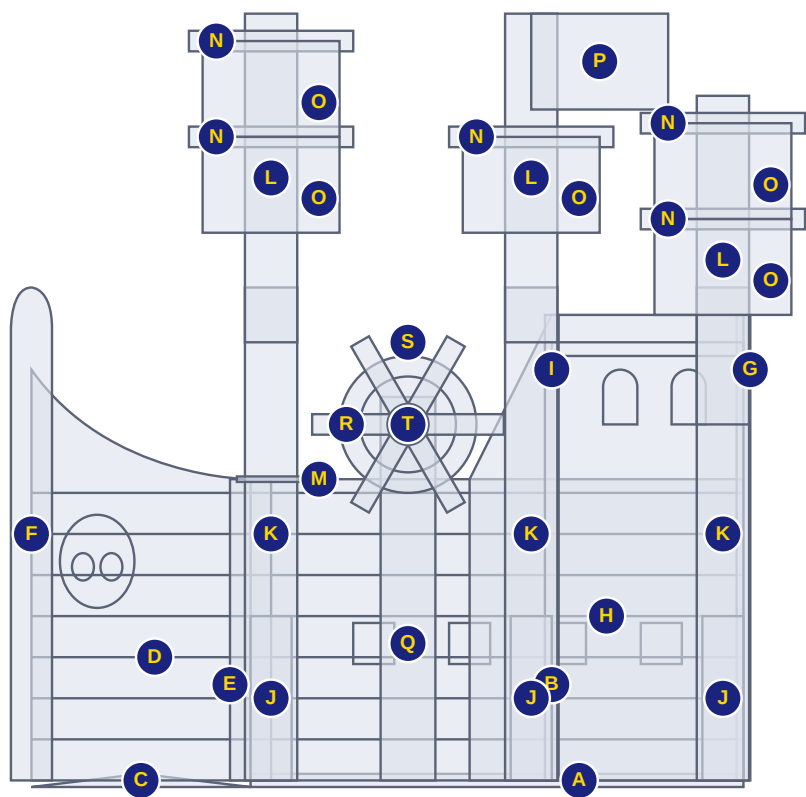
AGES 4–12	BOXES 6 Large Boxes	TIME 5–6 Hours	DIFF Advanced ***	PIECES 20 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
6 Large Boxes (sides at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm))
FINISHED SIZE:
52" long × 24" wide × 56" to the mast tops (132 × 61 × 142 cm); sides 22" high, castle 34"

MISSION GOAL:
Build the ship in the cover photo: a hull your child stands in, a pointed bow with a raised prow, a stern castle, 3 masts, 5 sails, a Jolly Roger, a ship's wheel, gunports and a skull.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

The finished build, side view, bow on the left like the photo, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD					
A	HULL FLOOR 36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)	CUT ×1	B	HULL SIDE 36" × 22" (91 × 56 cm)	CUT ×2
C	BOW FLOOR 24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm)	CUT ×1	D	BOW SIDE 20" × 30" (51 × 76 cm)	CUT ×2
E	BOW JOINT STRIP 6" × 22" (15 × 56 cm)	CUT ×2	F	PROW POST 6" × 36" (15 × 91 cm)	CUT ×1
G	TRANSOM 24" × 34" (61 × 86 cm)	CUT ×1	H	CASTLE SIDE 20" × 34" (51 × 86 cm)	CUT ×2
I	CASTLE FRONT WALL 24" × 34" (61 × 86 cm)	CUT ×1	J	MAST STEP 14" × 14" (36 × 36 cm)	CUT ×3
K	LONG MAST SHEET 36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm)	CUT ×3	L	SHORT MAST SHEET 24" × 12" (61 × 30 cm)	CUT ×3
M	MAST BEAM 32" × 5" (81 × 13 cm)	CUT ×1	N	SPAR SHEET 12" × 6" (30 × 15 cm)	CUT ×5
O	SAIL 10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm)	CUT ×5	P	FLAG 10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm)	CUT ×1
Q	HELM POST 18" × 28" (46 × 71 cm)	CUT ×1	R	WHEEL RIM 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)	CUT ×2
S	WHEEL SPOKE 14" × 1.5" (36 × 4 cm)	CUT ×3	T	WHEEL HUB 3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)	CUT ×2

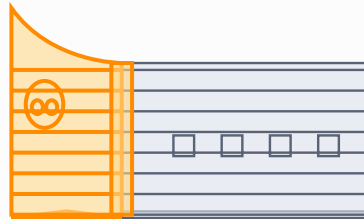
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

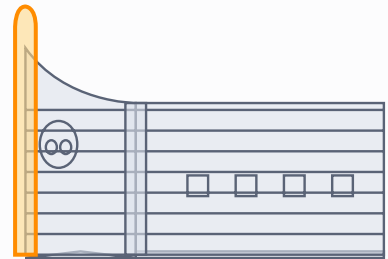
3 BUILD THE HULL



4 BUILD THE BOW



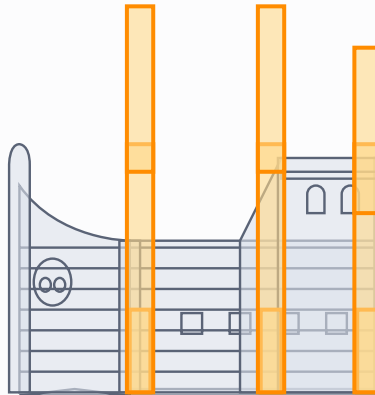
5 ADD THE PROW POST



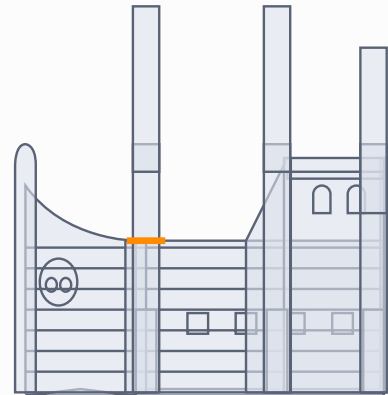
6 BUILD THE CASTLE



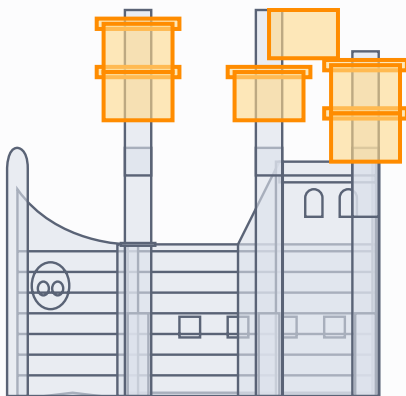
7 MAKE THE MASTS



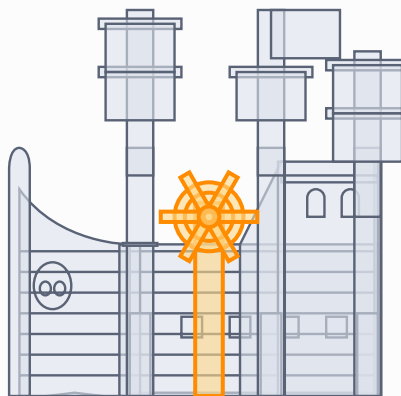
8 RAISE THE MASTS



9 HANG THE SPARS, SAILS & FLAG



11 BUILD THE SHIP'S WHEEL





HULL FLOOR

36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HULL FLOOR

x1

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

28"

32"

LONG EDGE — a Hull Side tapes here

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

28"

32"

FORE

MAIN

MIZZEN

LONG EDGE — a Hull Side tapes here

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.9" (20% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

36" × 24" (91 × 61 cm)

Flat bottom of the ship. Left end = front. The 3 mast sockets stand on it

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: Flat bottom of the ship. Left end = front. The 3 mast sockets stand on it



HULL SIDE

36" x 22" (91 x 56 cm) | Cut x2

CUT
x2

HULL SIDE

x2

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

28"

32"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

PORT

PORT

PORT

PORT

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" x 4.4" (20% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 36" x 22" (91 x 56 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

36" x 22" (91 x 56 cm)

Main side walls. Left end = front (meets the Bow Side), right end = stern

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

PAINT HERE — a painted detail, nothing is cut

NOTE: Main side walls. Left end = front (meets the Bow Side), right end = stern



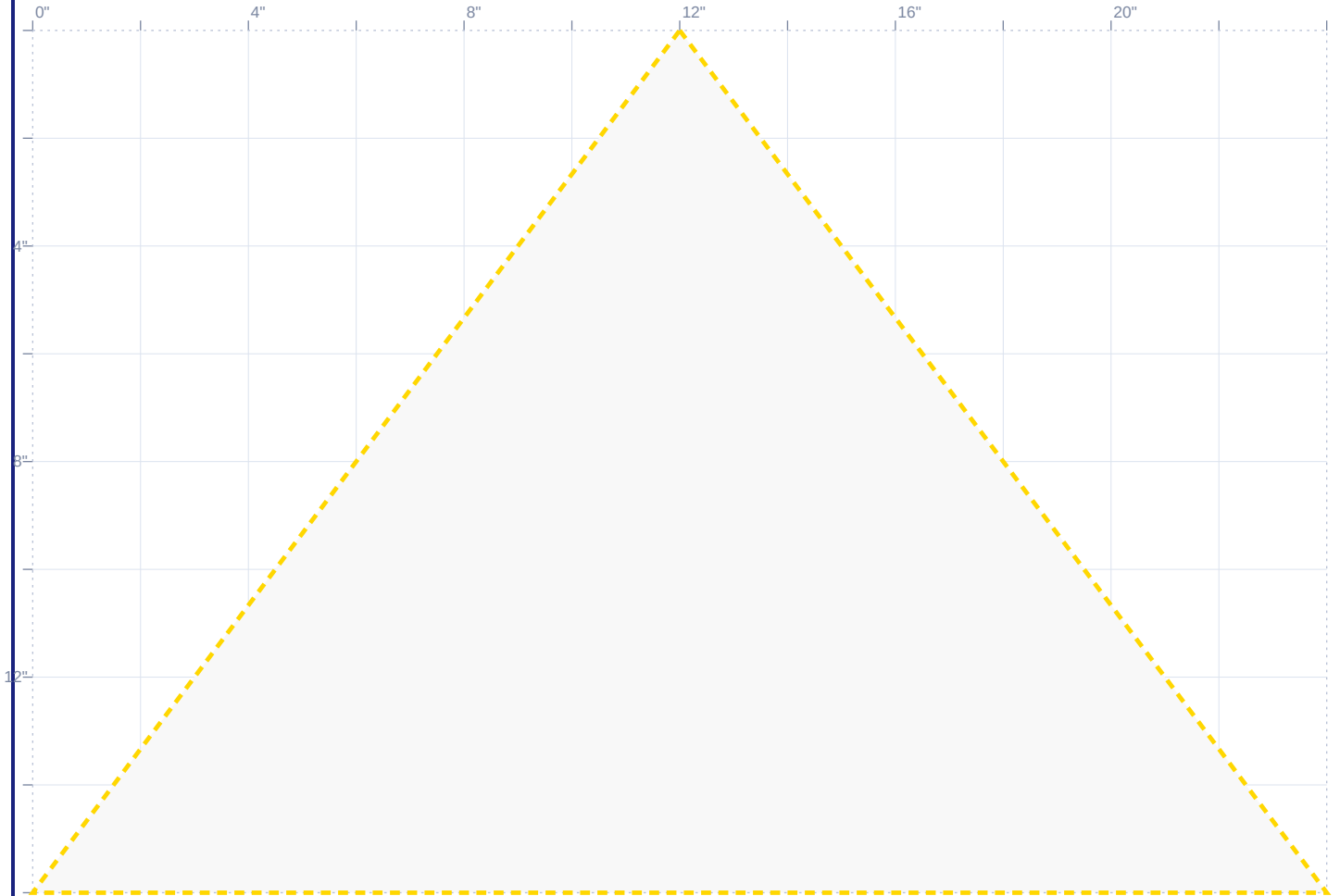
BOW FLOOR

24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

BOW FLOOR

×1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.9" (30% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark the centre of the top edge, 12" in. Draw straight lines from it to both bottom corners. The 24" bottom edge tapes to the Hull Floor; the point is the bow.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

24" × 16" (61 × 41 cm)

Triangle — the 24" edge tapes to the Hull Floor, the point is the front of the ship

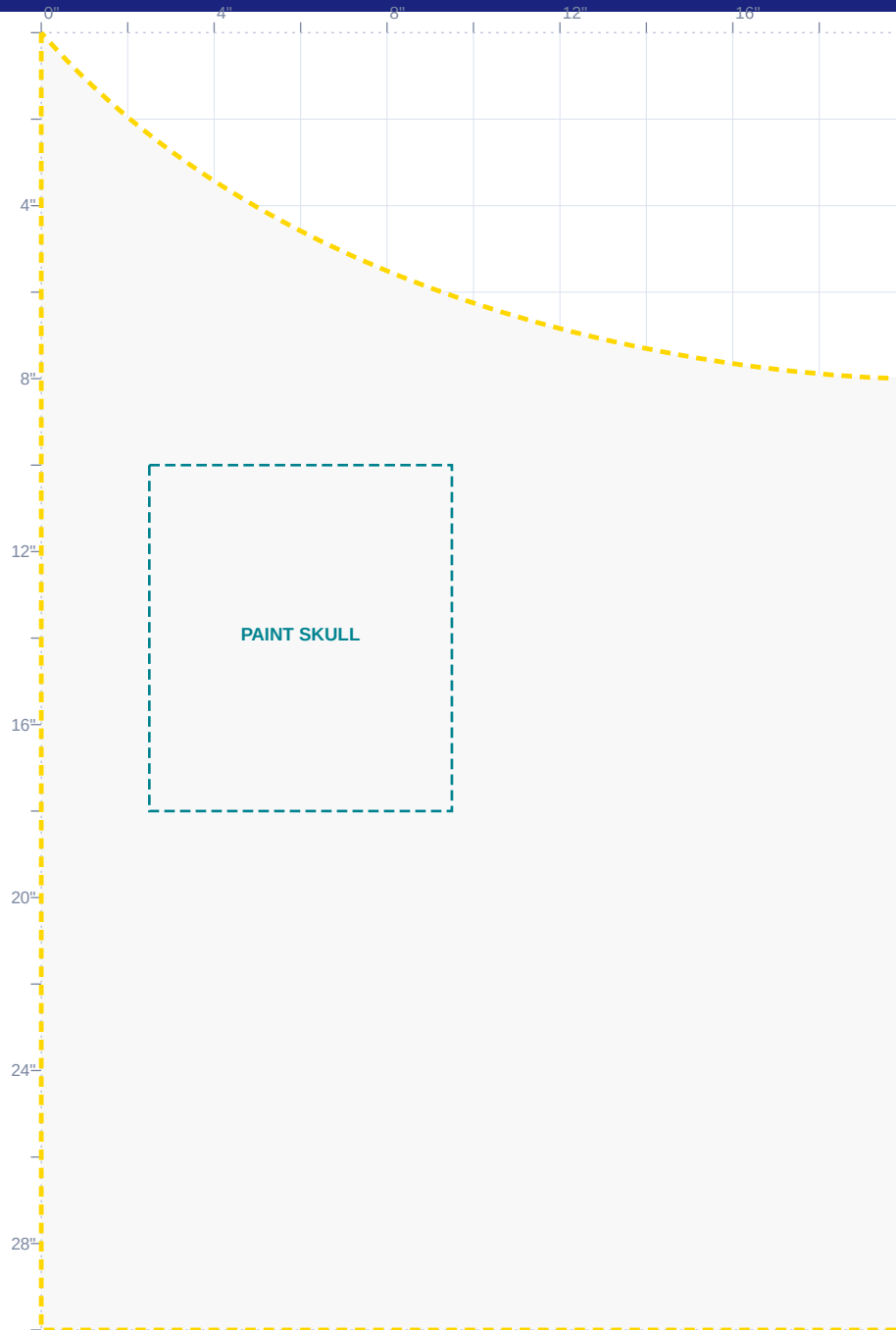
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: Triangle floor of the front of the ship

BOW SIDE

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 4.6" × 6.9" (23% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 20" × 30" (51 × 76 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Keep the left edge its full 30" and the bottom 20". Mark the right edge 22" up. Draw a smooth curve from that mark to the top-left corner through a point 8.5" in from the left and 24" up: flat at the right, rising steeply at the front. Cut 2; flip one over for the other side.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

20" × 30" (51 × 76 cm)

Bow side — tall point edge on the left, top curving down to the right

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

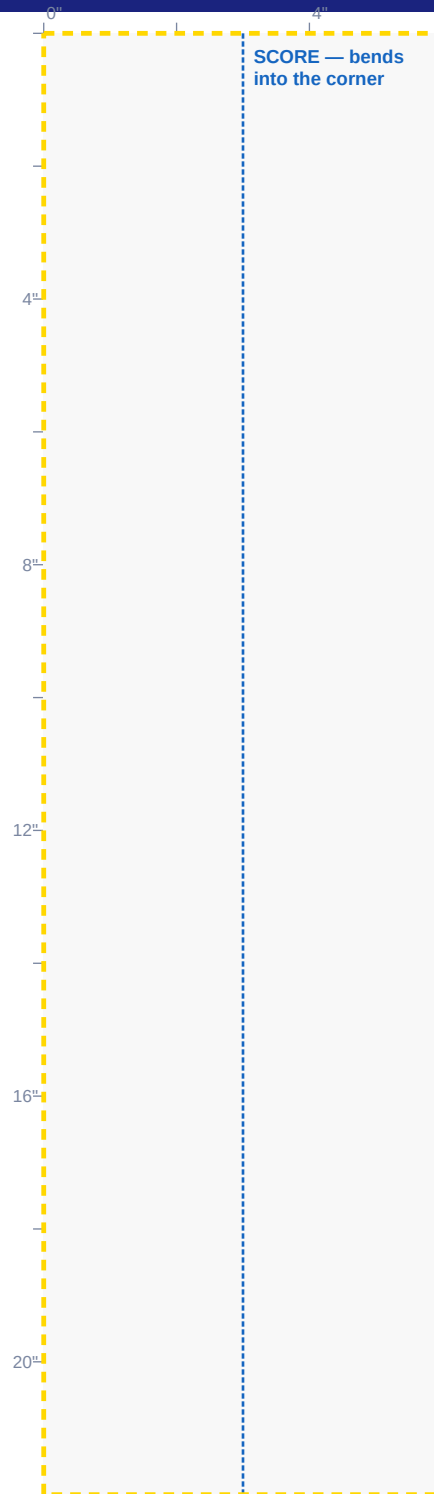
GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

PAINT HERE — a painted detail, nothing is cut

NOTE: Front walls; they angle in and meet in a point

BOW JOINT STRIP

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 2.1" × 7.6" (35% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 6" × 22" (15 × 56 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

6" × 22" (15 × 56 cm)

Tapes inside the corner where a Hull Side meets a Bow Side

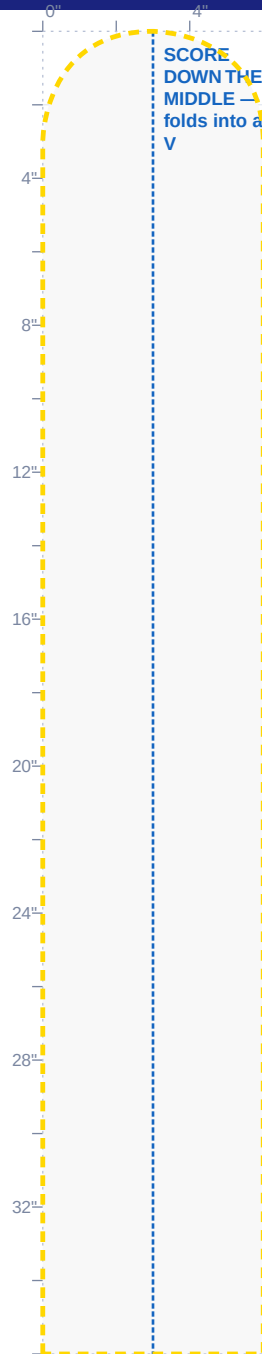
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Tapes inside the corner where a Hull Side meets a Bow Side

PROW POST

x1



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 1.1" × 6.9" (19% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 6" × 36" (15 × 91 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Mark both long edges 3" down from the top. Draw a curve from each mark up to the centre of the top edge (trace round a 6" saucer) so the top end is rounded.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

6" × 36" (15 × 91 cm)

Prow post — a long strip with a rounded top end

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

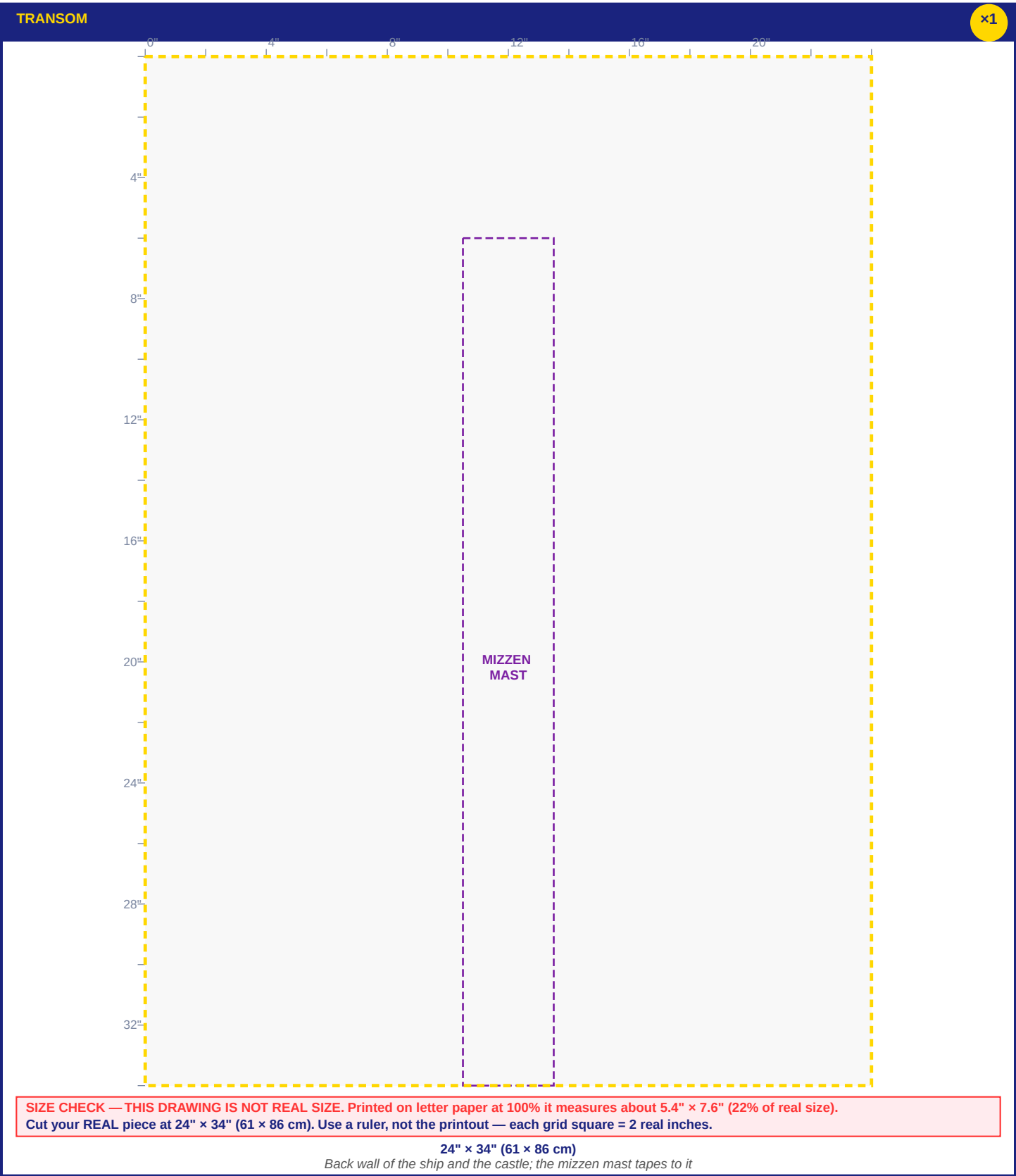
NOTE: Folds into a V over the bow point and stands 6" above it



TRANSOM

24" × 34" (61 × 86 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: Back wall of the ship and the castle; the mizzen mast tapes to it



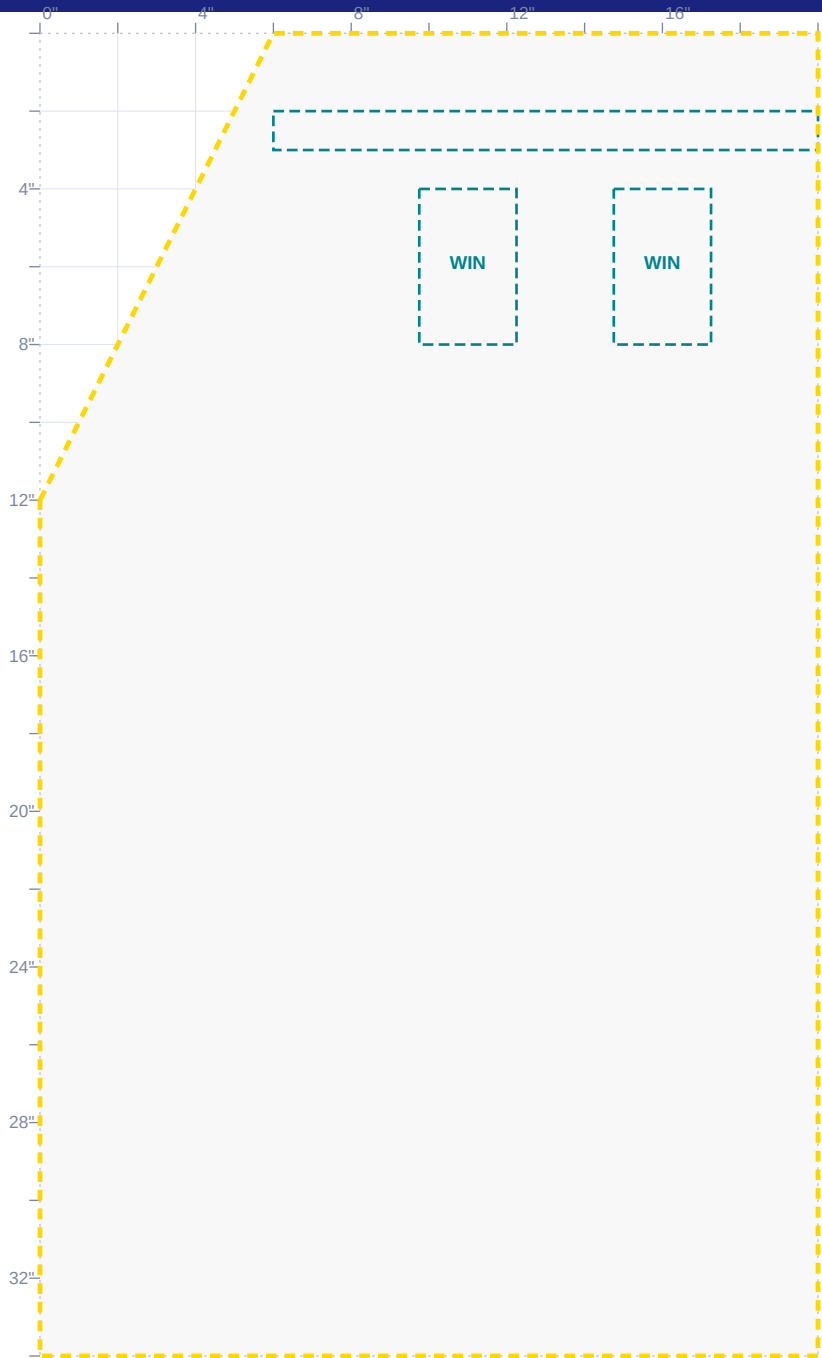
CASTLE SIDE

20" × 34" (51 × 86 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

CASTLE SIDE

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 4.1" × 6.9" (20% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 20" × 34" (51 × 86 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
Mark the left (front) edge 22" up from the bottom, and the top edge 6" in from the left. Join the two marks with a straight line and cut that corner off. Cut 2; flip one over for the other side.
Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

20" × 34" (51 × 86 cm)
Castle side — full height, with a sloped front corner where it rises from the deck

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	PAINT HERE — a painted detail, nothing is cut
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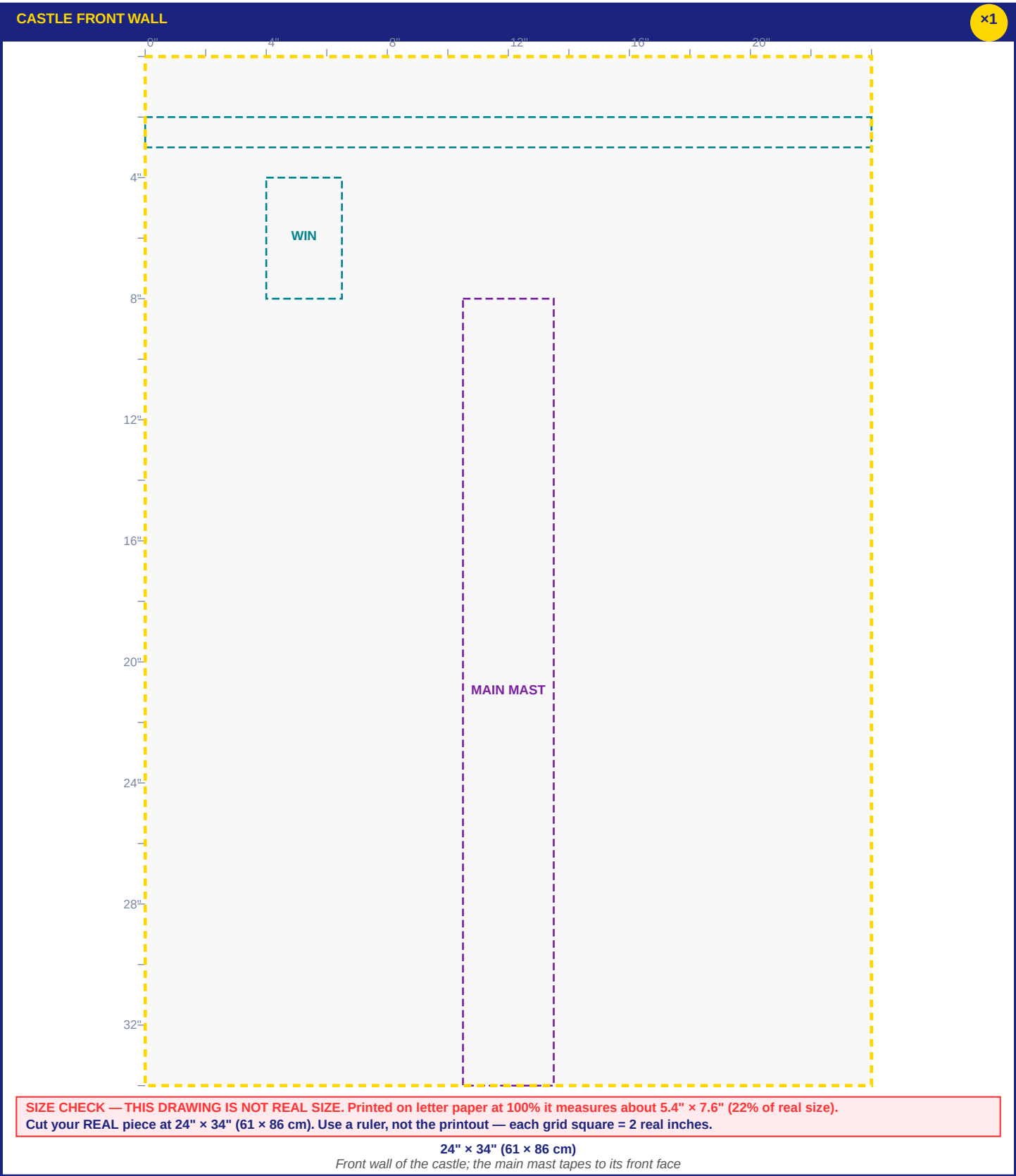
NOTE: Stands inside each Hull Side at the stern and raises it into the castle



CASTLE FRONT WALL

24" × 34" (61 × 86 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes	PAINT HERE — a painted detail, nothing is cut
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NOTE: Front wall of the castle; the main mast tapes to its front face



MAST STEP

14" x 14" (36 x 36 cm) | Cut x3

CUT
x3

MAST STEP

x3

0" 4" 8" 12"

12"

TAB

FOOT FLAPS: snip folds to here

14" x 14" (36 x 36 cm)

Folds into a 3" square socket; a mast stands in it

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" x 7.3" (52% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 14" x 14" (36 x 36 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Folds into a 3" square socket; a mast stands in it



LONG MAST SHEET

36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm) | Cut ×3

CUT
x3

LONG MAST SHEET

x3

0"4"8"12"16"20"24"28"32"

4"3"

ROLL

ROLL UP FROM A LONG EDGE — a tube about 3" across

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 2.4" (20% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

36" × 12" (91 × 30 cm)
Bottom part of a mast. Join a Short Mast Sheet on, then roll

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Bottom part of a mast. Join a Short Mast Sheet on, then roll



SHORT MAST SHEET

24" × 12" (61 × 30 cm) | Cut ×3

CUT
x3

SHORT MAST SHEET

x3



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (30% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 24" × 12" (61 × 30 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

24" × 12" (61 × 30 cm)

Top part of a mast. Overlaps the long sheet before rolling

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

ROLL — roll the cardboard tightly in this direction

NOTE: Top part of a mast. Overlaps the long sheet before rolling



MAST BEAM

×1

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 1.1" (23% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 32" × 5" (81 × 13 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

32" × 5" (81 × 13 cm)
Spans the ship from wall top to wall top and holds the fore mast upright

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE:

Spans the ship from wall top to wall top and holds the fore mast upright



SPAR SHEET

12" × 6" (30 × 15 cm) | Cut ×5

CUT
x5

SPAR SHEET

x5

0"4"8"

START HERE — roll up from this long edge into a pole

4"

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 3.6" (61% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 12" × 6" (30 × 15 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

12" × 6" (30 × 15 cm)
Rolled into the 5 cross poles the sails hang from

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Rolled into the 5 cross poles the sails hang from



SAIL

10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm) | Cut ×5

CUT
x5

SAIL

x5

0"4"8"

TOP EDGE — tapes over a spar

4"

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 5.1" (73% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm)

Cream paper, kraft paper or an old pillowcase — not cardboard

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Cream paper, kraft paper or an old pillowcase — not cardboard



FLAG

10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

FLAG

x1

0" 4" 8"

4"

SKULL

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 5.1" (73% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

10" × 7" (25 × 18 cm)
Black card or paper with a white skull and crossbones

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

PAINT HERE — a painted detail, nothing is cut

NOTE: Black card or paper with a white skull and crossbones



HELM POST

18" × 28" (46 × 71 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

HELM POST

x1

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 4.9" × 7.6" (27% of real size). Cut your REAL piece at 18" × 28" (46 × 71 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

18" × 28" (46 × 71 cm)
Folds into a 4" square post that holds the ship's wheel

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: Folds into a 4" square post that holds the ship's wheel



WHEEL RIM

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

WHEEL RIM

x2

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (69% of real size).
Cut your **REAL** piece at 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 10" across: pin a string 5" from the centre and swing a pencil round. From the same centre draw a 7" circle and cut it out, leaving a ring 1.5" wide. Cut 2.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)
Ring — a circle with its middle cut out

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.	CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)
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NOTE: Two rings taped face to face make one strong rim



WHEEL SPOKE

14" × 1.5" (36 × 4 cm) | Cut ×3

CUT
x3

WHEEL SPOKE

x3



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 0.8" (52% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 14" × 1.5" (36 × 4 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

14" × 1.5" (36 × 4 cm)
Three strips crossing at the centre make the 6 handles

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Three strips crossing at the centre make the 6 handles



WHEEL HUB

3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

WHEEL HUB

x2

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 6.9" × 6.9" (230% of real size — BIGGER than the REAL piece at 3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 3" across. Trace round a small cup or a roll of tape.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

3" × 3" (8 × 8 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: One on each face of the wheel centre

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD PIRATE SHIP

CARDBOARD PIECES — 20 TOTAL (6 Large Boxes (sides at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm)))

×1 Hull Floor 36" × 24" <i>Flat bottom of the ship. Left end = front. The 3 mast sockets stand on it</i>	×3 Long Mast Sheet 36" × 12" <i>Bottom part of a mast. Join a Short Mast Sheet on, then roll</i>
×2 Hull Side 36" × 22" <i>Main side walls. Left end = front (meets the Bow Side), right end = stern</i>	×3 Short Mast Sheet 24" × 12" <i>Top part of a mast. Overlaps the long sheet before rolling</i>
×1 Bow Floor 24" × 16" <i>Triangle floor of the front of the ship</i>	×1 Mast Beam 32" × 5" <i>Spans the ship from wall top to wall top and holds the fore mast upright</i>
×2 Bow Side 20" × 30" <i>Front walls; they angle in and meet in a point</i>	×5 Spar Sheet 12" × 6" <i>Rolled into the 5 cross poles the sails hang from</i>
×2 Bow Joint Strip 6" × 22" <i>Tapes inside the corner where a Hull Side meets a Bow Side</i>	×5 Sail 10" × 7" <i>Cream paper, kraft paper or an old pillowcase — not cardboard</i>
×1 Prow Post 6" × 36" <i>Folds into a V over the bow point and stands 6" above it</i>	×1 Flag 10" × 7" <i>Black card or paper with a white skull and crossbones</i>
×1 Transom 24" × 34" <i>Back wall of the ship and the castle; the mizzen mast tapes to it</i>	×1 Helm Post 18" × 28" <i>Folds into a 4" square post that holds the ship's wheel</i>
×2 Castle Side 20" × 34" <i>Stands inside each Hull Side at the stern and raises it into the castle</i>	×2 Wheel Rim 10" × 10" <i>Two rings taped face to face make one strong rim</i>
×1 Castle Front Wall 24" × 34" <i>Front wall of the castle; the main mast tapes to its front face</i>	×3 Wheel Spoke 14" × 1.5" <i>Three strips crossing at the centre make the 6 handles</i>
×3 Mast Step 14" × 14" <i>Folds into a 3" square socket; a mast stands in it</i>	×2 Wheel Hub 3" × 3" <i>One on each face of the wheel centre</i>

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- + 6 large cardboard boxes (flattened)
- + Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY
- + Packing tape (3+ rolls)
- + Cream paper, kraft paper or an old pillowcase for 5 sails
- + String or garden twine (about 50 feet)
- + Paint or markers: black, white, orange, dark green, brown
- + Yardstick, pencil and a ball of string
- + Dinner plate, saucer and mug to trace circles

FUN FACT!

Blackbeard's ship, Queen Anne's Revenge, was about 100 feet long. Yours is just over 4 feet long — and it fits in the living room.

CHALLENGE!

Crew challenge: the captain steers while the crew shouts "Land ho!", "Storm ahead!" or "Treasure!" — for each call the captain spins the wheel and gives an order. Swap captains every 5 calls.

1 STEP 1: FLATTEN & PLAN

Flatten all the boxes. Mark out every template by its letter: A, B x2, C, D x2, E x2, F, G, H x2, I, J x3, K x3, L x3, M, N x5, P, Q, R x2, S x3 and T x2. Lay the big walls (B, D, G, H, I) so the cardboard ridges run UP the wall, and K, L and N so the ridges run along their LONG edge — they roll easily that way. Template O (x5) is paper or cloth, not cardboard.

2 STEP 2: CUT OUT THE PARTS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut every outline on the gold lines. Cut the curved and sloped edges on D, F and H, the triangle C, and the circles R and T. Cut one of each pair first and trace it for the second so they match. Cut the middle out of both R rings. Cut the 3.5" (9 cm) hole out of M. Cut O and P from paper, cloth or thin card.

SAFETY: Adult uses the box cutter. Children trace and cut paper only.

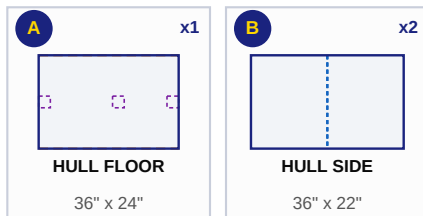
3 STEP 3: BUILD THE HULL

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay the Hull Floor flat, front end to the left. Stand a Hull Side on each long edge, outside the floor, front ends to the left, and tape both bottom seams inside and outside. The sides now stand 24" (61 cm) apart and 22" (56 cm) high.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the walls, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



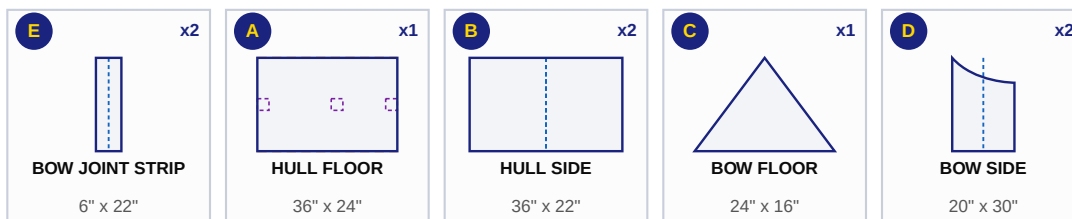
4 STEP 4: BUILD THE BOW

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the long edge of the Bow Floor to the front end of the Hull Floor, point forward. Stand a Bow Side at the front of each Hull Side, tall edge forward, and bend both in until their tall edges meet over the point of the Bow Floor; tape them to it and to each other inside. Tape a Bow Joint Strip inside each corner where a Hull Side meets a Bow Side, score line in the corner.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the bow, one tapes.

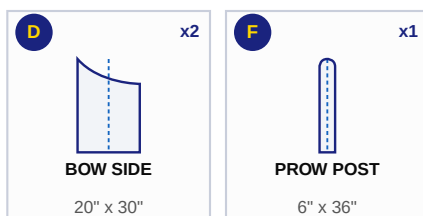
PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5 STEP 5: ADD THE PROW POST

Fold the Prow Post down its score line into a V, rounded end up. Slide it over the bow point so it covers the seam from the floor to the top, and tape it to both Bow Sides. Its top stands 6" (15 cm) above the bow, like the curled prow in the photo.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



6

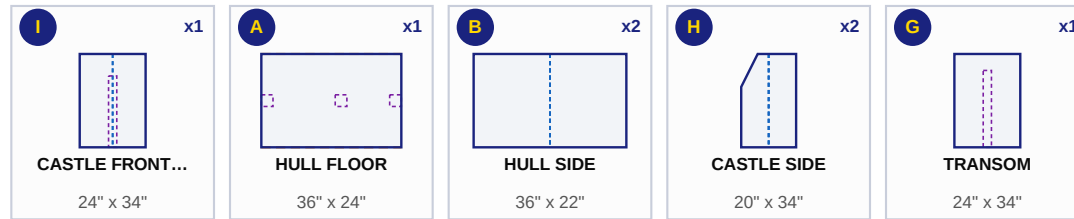
STEP 6: BUILD THE CASTLE

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the Transom across the stern end, standing on the Hull Floor between the Hull Sides. Stand a Castle Side inside each Hull Side at the stern, sloped corner forward, against the Transom, and tape it to the Hull Side all over. Stand the Castle Front Wall across the hull 14" (36 cm) from the stern, between the Castle Sides, and tape it to them and to the floor. The castle is an open-topped box 34" (86 cm) high, like the photo.

SAFETY: The castle is a wall, not a deck: nobody climbs, sits or stands on it.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



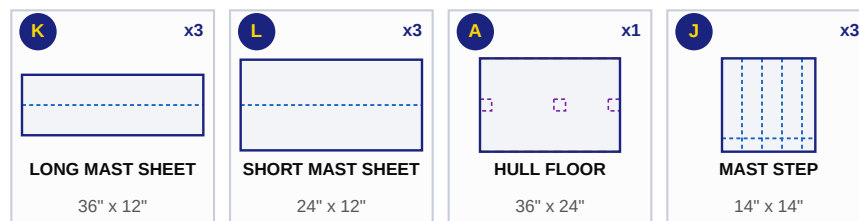
7

STEP 7: MAKE THE MASTS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

For each of the 3 masts, lay a Short Mast Sheet on the end of a Long Mast Sheet, overlapping 4" (10 cm), and tape both faces. For the mizzen (the back mast) overlap 10" (25 cm) instead, so it is shorter, like the photo. Roll each joined sheet up from a long edge into a tube about 3" (8 cm) across and tape the seam every 4" (10 cm). Fold each Mast Step into a 3" (8 cm) square socket, snip up each fold line to the FOOT FLAPS line, fold the 4 flaps out and tape them to the FORE, MAIN and MIZZEN marks on the Hull Floor.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



8

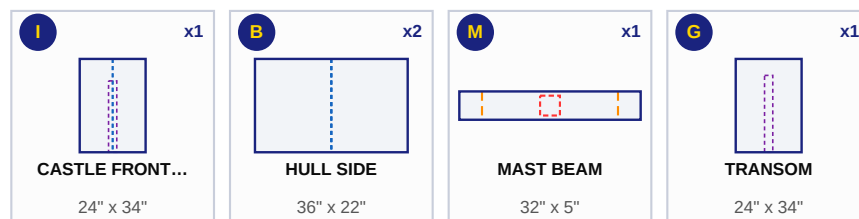
STEP 8: RAISE THE MASTS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Fore mast: push it down through the hole in the Mast Beam and into the FORE socket, fold the beam ends down over the tops of the Hull Sides and tape them. Main mast: stand it in the MAIN socket against the Castle Front Wall and tape it to the wall at two heights. Mizzen: stand it in its socket against the Transom and tape it the same way.

SAFETY: Masts are decoration: no pulling, climbing or leaning on them.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

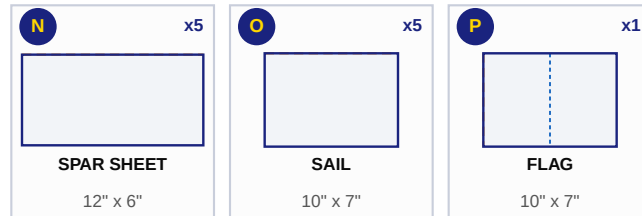


9

STEP 9: HANG THE SPARS, SAILS & FLAG

Roll each Spar Sheet up from a long edge into a 12" (30 cm) pole and wrap tape round each end 6 times to make the knobs. Crumple each Sail, flatten it, and tape its top edge over a spar so it hangs and billows. Fore mast and mizzen: tape a spar across 2" (5 cm) below the top and another 9" (23 cm) below the top, each with a sail. Main mast: one spar with a sail 9" (23 cm) below the top, and tape the Flag's edge to the main mast top so it flies toward the stern.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



10

STEP 10: RIG THE ROPES

Lash every spar to its mast with string wound in an X, like the photo. Tie 2 strings from each mast top down to the top edges of the walls on either side and pull them snug: they hold the masts straight. Tie a string from each mast top to both ends of each spar on it.

SAFETY: Keep strings above the child's head height or taped flat; no loose loops.

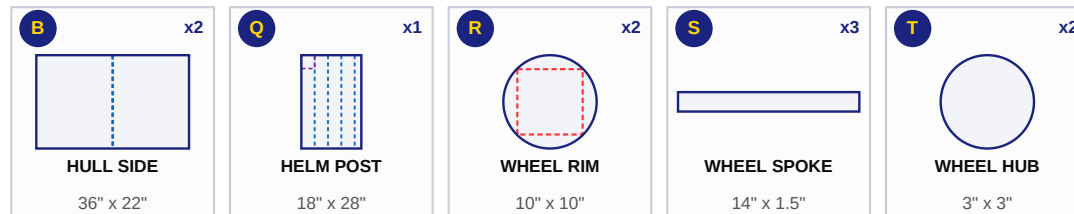
11

STEP 11: BUILD THE SHIP'S WHEEL

Tape the 2 Wheel Rims face to face. Lay the 3 Wheel Spokes across the ring like a star, crossing at the centre, ends 2" (5 cm) past the rim, and tape them to the ring. Tape a Wheel Hub on each face of the centre. Fold the Helm Post into a 4" (10 cm) square post and tape the seam. Stand it inside one Hull Side, halfway between the fore mast and the castle, and tape it to the wall and floor. Tape the wheel to its inner face on the HUB mark: the hub is 26" (66 cm) off the floor.

SAFETY: Wheel at the captain's chest; nothing sharp at the spoke ends.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



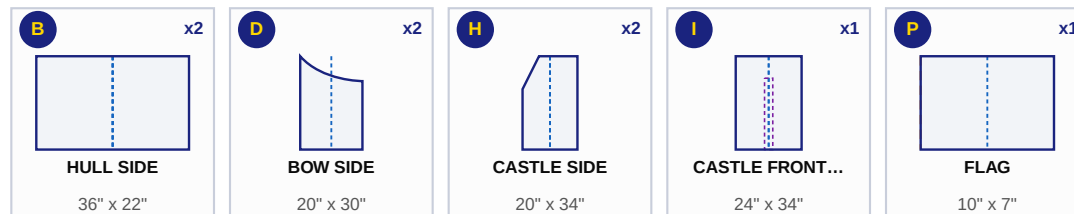
12

STEP 12: PAINT THE SHIP

Leave the cardboard brown like the photo. Draw brown plank lines along the outside every 3" (8 cm). On each Hull Side paint the 4 PORT squares black with a 0.5" (1 cm) dark green frame. Paint a white skull on each Bow Side on the SKULL mark, with black eyes and nose. On the Castle Sides and front wall paint the WIN marks as black arched windows with a green frame, and the thin bar as a 1" (3 cm) orange stripe. Paint the outer edge of the wheel ring and both hubs orange. Paint the Flag black with a white skull and crossbones.

SAFETY: Water-based paint only.

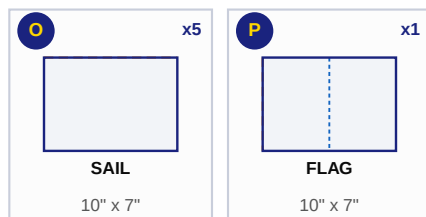
PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



13

STEP 13: QUALITY CHECK

The captain steps in over the side and stands at the wheel. The bow comes to a point with the prow above it, the castle has its windows and stripe, 3 masts stand straight with 5 sails and the flag, and 4 gunports and the skull show on the side. Compare to the cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP**QUALITY CHECK!**

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations